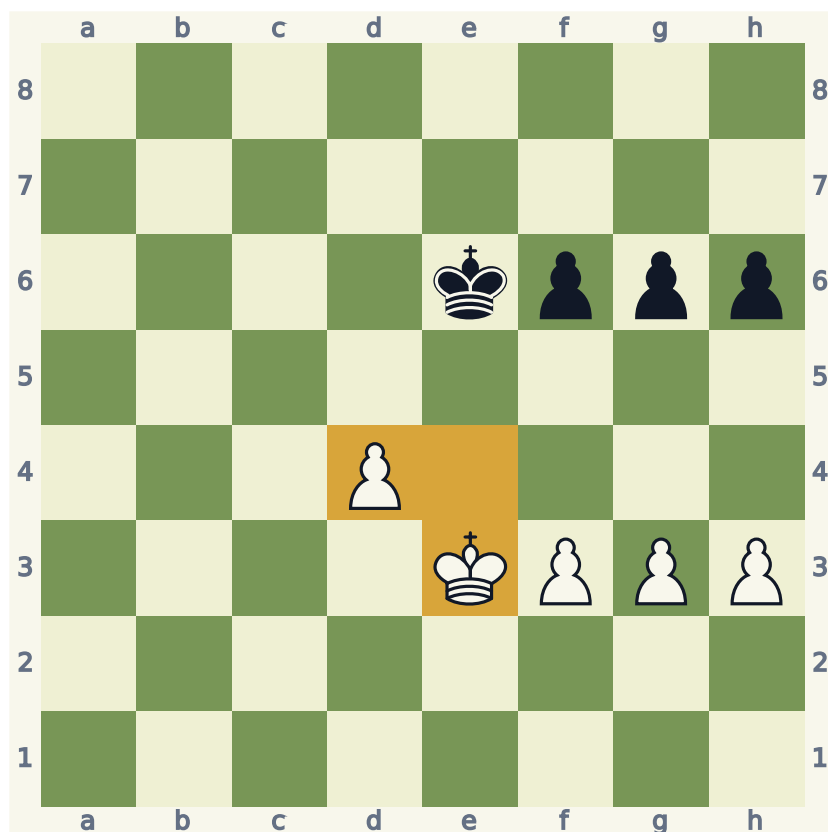


Convert an advantage

Improve, restrict counterplay, and choose the right ending.

Conversion means turning an advantage into a concrete result. Improve the least active piece, reduce the opponent's useful counterplay and choose exchanges that preserve winning resources. In endings, active kings, passed pawns and rook activity may matter more than a visually attractive pawn structure.

MODEL A | WHITE TO MOVE



READ THE POSITION

- White has an extra central passed pawn on d4.
- The kings must respect opposition and pawn attacks.
- White should coordinate the king before advancing the passer.

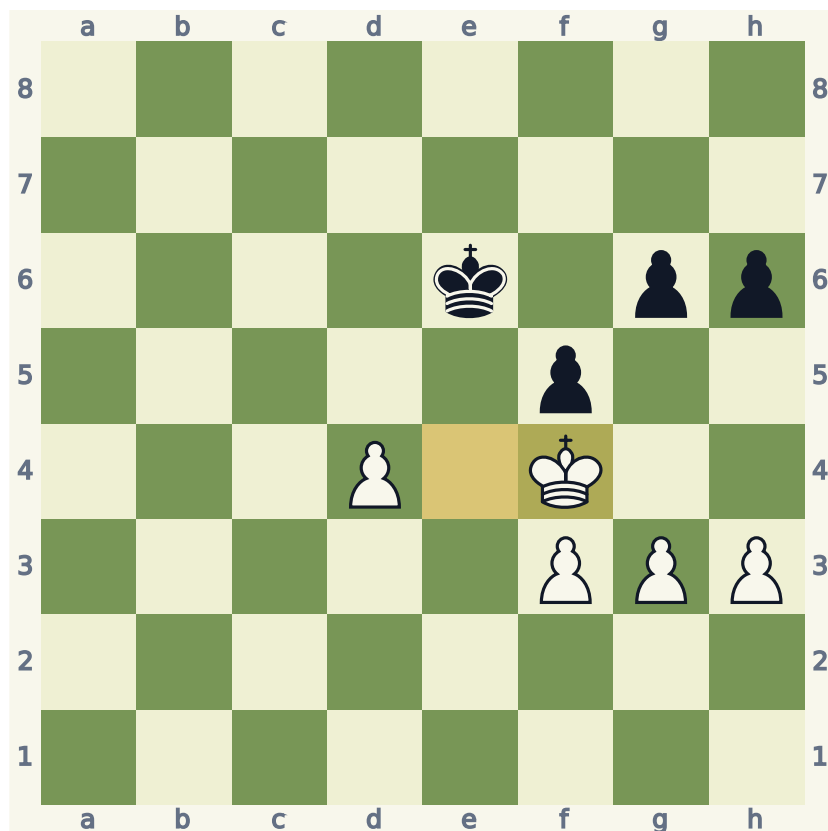
REMEMBER

- Reduce useful counterplay, not just material.
- Activate the king when it is safe.
- Verify the final pawn ending before exchanging.

Follow the logic

1. Ke4 f5+ 2. Kf4

MODEL A | POSITION AFTER THE LINE



Ke4

Centralize while keeping contact with the passer. The move approaches useful squares without pushing the pawn beyond support.

...f5+

Black creates a forcing reply. The defender should seek active resources rather than simply retreating.

Kf4

Step to a legal active square and keep the pawn position under control. The line illustrates technique, not a complete proof of the ending's result.

THE OPPONENT'S PLAN

Black can attack the pawn chain, use opposition and seek exchanges that leave too few winning resources. White must calculate pawn races and king access instead of assuming that an extra pawn wins itself.

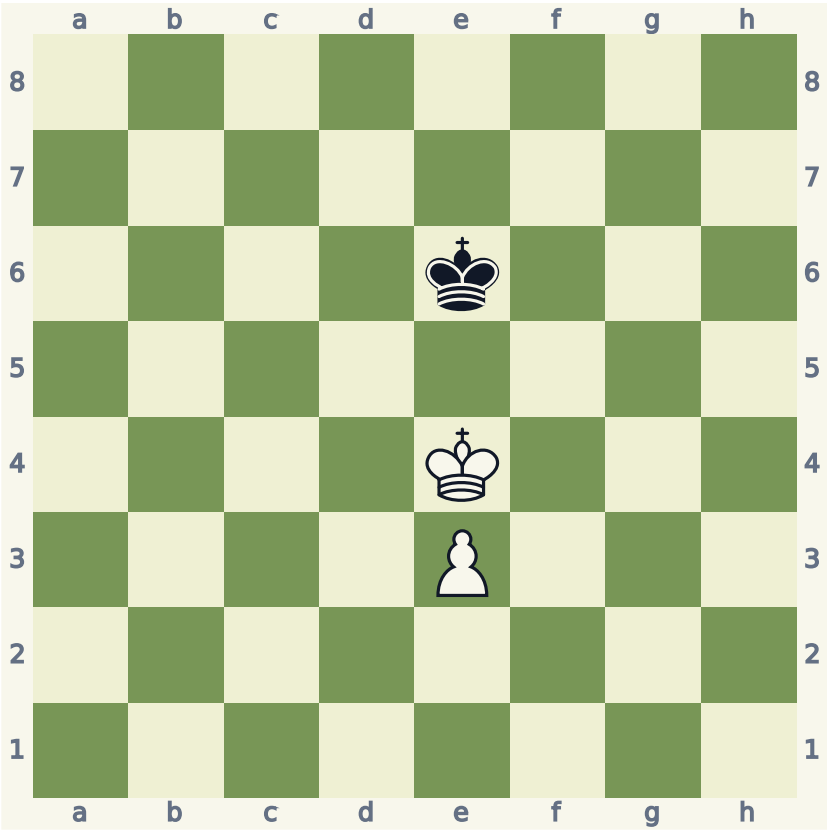
WHEN THE IDEA FAILS

Before exchanging the last pieces, calculate the pawn ending. A general material advantage does not override a drawn king-and-pawn position. Do not rush a passed pawn if the king needs to lead it.

Find the plan

Set a timer for 6 minutes. Write the reasons, not just a move.

EXERCISE B | WHITE TO MOVE



- 1. What does Black achieve by keeping the kings opposed?
- 2. Why does a pawn move alter the opposition?
- 3. Does the sample line prove that White wins?

CHANGE ONE FEATURE

For a white pawn still on e3, which king squares would guarantee promotion against a lone king if reached legally?

YOUR PLAN, THE OPPONENT'S REPLY, AND THE RESULTING POSITION

Position code (FEN): 8/8/4k3/8/4K3/4P3/8/8 w - - 0 1

Answers and transfer

1. Black keeps the white king from simply walking forward. After Kd4 ...Kd6, the kings face each other with one square between them and White to move. Black has the direct opposition.
2. e4 uses a pawn tempo and changes the geometry, but Black can answer ...Ke6 and continue guarding entry squares. Opposition is a tool for controlling king access, not a rule that every opposition gain wins.
3. No. This starting king-and-pawn position is drawn with correct defense. The sample shows how the defender maintains access control; it is a warning to verify the ending before trading into it. White's king has not secured a key square on d5, e5 or f5.

ONE ILLUSTRATIVE LEGAL LINE

1. Kd4 Kd6 2. e4 Ke6

Changed feature: The key squares are d5, e5 and f5. Reaching one with the king secures the usual non-rook-pawn winning method; merely standing on e4 does not.

APPLY IT TO YOUR GAMES

Play the final exercise from both sides. The defender practices opposition; the attacker tries to reach d5, e5 or f5 without losing the pawn.

Self-check: Award 0-2 points per numbered answer: 1 for the relevant fact, 1 for its consequence. Add 2 for the changed-feature answer. Revisit the lesson at 5/8 or below; repeat from memory tomorrow and one week later.

Related topics: 01, 18, 22. | Reference links and notation key: 00_Start_Here.pdf.